

SETUP GUIDE

Tally Live Entity Dashboard

Complete install walkthrough — from a blank Windows PC with Tally installed, to a live dashboard at a local web address.

Written for someone doing this for the first time on a machine that has never run this project before.

Covers: enabling Tally's data connection, installing Python, copying the project, first connectivity test, running the dashboard, running it automatically every time the PC starts, and fixing the most common problems.

Tally Live Entity Dashboard — Setup Guide

1. What you need before starting	2
2. Enable Tally's data connection (on the Tally PC)	2
3. Install Python	3
4. Copy the project onto the target PC	3
5. Install the app's dependencies	3
6. Configure the app	4
7. If the dashboard PC is different from the Tally PC	4
8. First connectivity test	5
9. Run the dashboard	5
10. Make it start automatically every login	6
11. Using the dashboard day to day	6
12. Troubleshooting	7

1. What you need before starting

- A Windows PC with **Tally ERP 9 or TallyPrime** already installed, with at least one company created and data in it.
- The **TallyTracker project folder** — everything currently on the machine this guide was generated on, zipped up.
- Internet access on the target PC once, to install Python (or a Python installer downloaded ahead of time).
- About 20 minutes, uninterrupted.

GOOD TO KNOW

Nothing here modifies Tally's own data. The app only reads from Tally over a local network connection — it cannot write anything back into Tally, delete anything, or change any ledger.

2. Enable Tally's data connection (on the Tally PC)

Do this on the computer where Tally itself runs. Tally needs its built-in HTTP/XML data server turned on — it's off by default.

If you're on Tally.ERP 9

- 1 Open Tally, load your company.**
From the Gateway of Tally screen, press **F1** (Help).
- 2 Go to Settings → Connectivity.**
Look for "Client/Server configuration" (sometimes under Advanced Configuration, **F12**).
- 3 Set TCP/IP Port to 9000.**
This is the port the dashboard will connect to. Leave it at 9000 unless you have a specific reason to change it.
- 4 Enable the ODBC / HTTP-XML server option.**
The exact label varies by release — look for anything mentioning "Enable ODBC" or "HTTP Server."
- 5 Accept and restart Tally.**
Close and reopen Tally with the company loaded so the setting takes effect.

If you're on TallyPrime

- 1 Open Tally, load your company.**
Press **F1** (Help) from any screen.
- 2 Go to Settings → Connectivity → Client/Server configuration.**
- 3 Set the port to 9000**
and turn on the option that lets other applications connect (again, worded slightly differently release to release — anything about enabling the company for external connections / ODBC).
- 4 Save and restart Tally**
with the company loaded.

IF MENU WORDING DOESN'T MATCH EXACTLY

Tally changes this menu's exact wording between releases. Search Tally's own Help (**F1**) for "ODBC" or "HTTP XML Server" from wherever you are — it will jump to the right screen. The important end result is: a TCP port (9000) is open and Tally is listening on it while a company is loaded.

3. Install Python

1 Go to python.org/downloads

on the target PC and download the latest Python 3 installer for Windows.

2 Run the installer.

On the very first screen, tick the checkbox "Add python.exe to PATH" at the bottom before clicking Install Now. This step is easy to miss and everything below depends on it.

3 Verify it worked.

Open Command Prompt (Start menu → type `cmd` → Enter) and run:

```
python --version
```

It should print something like `Python 3.12.4`. If it says "not recognized," Python wasn't added to PATH — reinstall and tick the checkbox.

4. Copy the project onto the target PC

1 Zip the whole `TallyTracker` folder

on the machine you have it on now (right-click the folder → Send to → Compressed (zipped) folder).

2 Move it to the target PC

any way that's convenient — USB drive, a shared network folder, email to yourself, cloud storage, whatever's easiest.

3 Unzip it

somewhere simple, e.g. `C:\TallyTracker` or the Desktop. The rest of this guide assumes you can open Command Prompt inside that folder.

5. Install the app's dependencies

1 Open Command Prompt inside the project's `backend` folder.

Easiest way: open the `backend` folder in File Explorer, click the address bar, type `cmd`, press Enter.

2 Run:

```
python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
```

This downloads FastAPI, uvicorn, and the few other libraries the app needs. Takes a minute or two.

6. Configure the app

- 1 **Open** `backend\config.yaml`
in Notepad.
- 2 **Set** `tally.company_name`
to your exact company name as it appears in Tally.
- 3 **Leave** `tally.host` **as** `localhost`
if the dashboard will run on the *same* PC as Tally. Change it if not — see the next section.
- 4 **Save the file.**

7. If the dashboard PC is different from the Tally PC

Skip this section entirely if both run on the same computer.

If the dashboard will run on a different PC than Tally (both on the same office network), two extra things are needed:

7a. Point the app at Tally's PC

1 On the Tally PC

, open Command Prompt and run `ipconfig`. Note the `IPv4 Address` (looks like `192.168.1.XX`).

2 On the dashboard PC

, edit `backend\config.yaml` and set `tally.host` to that IP address instead of `localhost`.

7b. Open the firewall on the Tally PC

1 On the Tally PC

, open

Windows Defender Firewall with Advanced Security

(search for it in the Start menu).

2 Click "Inbound Rules" → "New Rule."

3 Choose "Port," click Next.

Choose TCP, and enter `9000` as the specific port.

4 Choose "Allow the connection," click Next

through the profile screen (leave all three ticked — Domain/Private/Public), and name it something like `Tally XML Server`.

WITHOUT THIS STEP

The dashboard PC's requests to port 9000 will silently time out even though Tally itself is running fine — Windows Firewall blocks unsolicited inbound connections by default.

8. First connectivity test

Do this with Tally open and your company loaded.

1 In Command Prompt, inside `backend`, run:

```
python phase0_raw_probe.py
```

Should print a block of raw XML text. If it instead prints a connection error, Tally's data connection isn't reachable yet — go back to step 2 (or 7, if on separate PCs).

2 Then run:

```
python test_tally_client.py
```

This pulls your real ledgers, bills, and stock and prints them. Check the numbers look right. If some rows show as empty or warnings appear about missing fields, that means Tally's exact XML tags on your version differ slightly — see Troubleshooting.

9. Run the dashboard

- 1 In Command Prompt, inside `backend`, run:

```
python run_server.py
```

A window stays open showing log lines — leave it running.

- 2 Open a web browser

and go to:

```
http://127.0.0.1:8731/
```

(If the dashboard is on a different PC than the one you're browsing from, use that PC's IP address instead of `127.0.0.1`, e.g. `http://192.168.1.XX:8731/`.)

- 3 Click "Refresh now"

in the top right to pull the first real sync from Tally.

10. Make it start automatically every login

So you never have to manually run anything again — the dashboard starts itself, hidden, every time the PC starts, and quietly waits if Tally isn't open yet.

1 Close the window from Step 9

(press Ctrl+C in it, or just close it).

2 In Command Prompt, inside `backend`, run:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install_task.ps1
```

3 Done.

From now on, the dashboard is available at `http://127.0.0.1:8731/` from the moment you log into Windows. No console window appears. If it crashes for any reason it restarts itself automatically.

To remove this later: run `powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File uninstall_task.ps1` from the same folder.

11. Using the dashboard day to day

Section	What it shows
Top tiles	Total receivables, total payables, net position, count of entities with an overdue bill
Entities table	Every customer/vendor once each, balance, open/overdue bill counts — click a row for detail
Entity detail panel	That party's bills, a balance history chart, and your own followup notes
Followup notes	Type a note ("Called, promised payment Friday"), pick a status, Add note — these are never overwritten by syncing with Tally
Stock table	Item, quantity, unit, value — tick "Low stock only" to filter
Margin Notes (right side)	Every detected change, newest first — new bills, settled bills, balance moves, stock moves
Red banner at top	Appears only when Tally is closed/unreachable — shows the last good sync time, data underneath is still the last-known-good numbers

The page refreshes itself every 30 seconds. "Refresh now" forces an immediate sync instead of waiting for the next automatic cycle (every 5 minutes by default — changeable in `config.yaml` under `polling.interval_minutes`).

12. Troubleshooting

Dashboard shows "Tally offline" but Tally is open

- Confirm a company is actually loaded in Tally (not just the app open).
- Re-check Section 2 — the HTTP/ODBC server setting resets sometimes after a Tally update.
- If dashboard and Tally are on different PCs, re-check Section 7 (host IP + firewall).
- Run `python phase0_raw_probe.py` from `backend` directly — it gives the plainest error message.

Some bill or stock numbers look wrong or blank

FIX

Run this from `backend` (PowerShell):

```
$env:TALLY_CLIENT_DEBUG="1"
python test_tally_client.py
```

This prints the raw XML Tally actually sent back. Compare it against `tally_client.py` — only that one file needs adjusting, since it's the only file that knows Tally's field names.

"python is not recognized"

Python wasn't added to PATH during install — go back to Section 3, reinstall, tick "Add python.exe to PATH."

Port 8731 already in use

Open PowerShell and run:

```
Get-NetTCPConnection -LocalPort 8731 -State Listen | Select-Object OwningProcess
Stop-Process -Id <that number> -Force
```

Want to start over with a clean, empty database

Close the dashboard, delete `backend\tally.db`, start it again — a fresh empty one is created automatically and the next sync repopulates it from Tally.